



Nonflowering plants

These are the oldest plants and include ferns and mosses, which reproduce using spores. Conifers, which produce naked (not enclosed) seeds, also belong to this group.

Liverworts



Common liverwort

Mosses



Star moss

Hornworts



Smooth hornwort

Lycopods



Stiff clubmoss

The plant kingdom

There are around 400,000 different types of plants, and botanists—scientists specializing in plants—discover new ones all the time. Hundreds of millions of years ago, the first plants were small and did not flower. Over time, the process of evolution has created a fantastic range of plants, from simple ferns to stunning cherry blossoms and spiky cacti. To bring order to this incredible variety, botanists divide up plants into nonflowering and flowering plants. Within these categories, there are many species, and some of them are shown here.

Grasses



Little bluestem

Daisies



Figaro dahlia